

EXPLORING SPACE

PERSEVERANCE ROVER

Surveying Mars

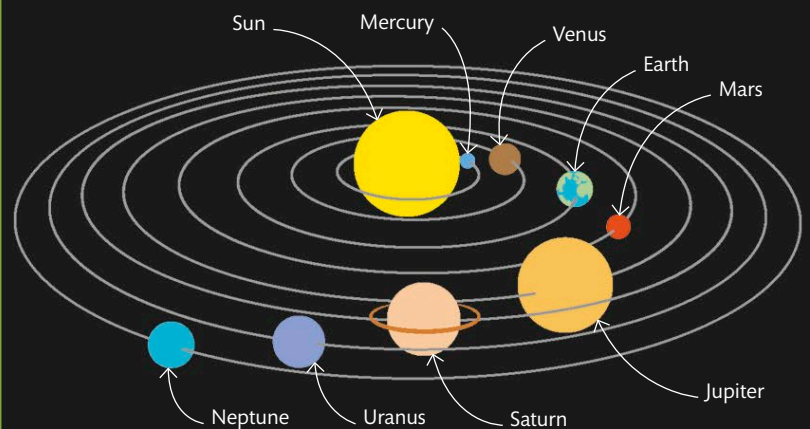
Perseverance landed on Mars inside the Jezero Crater, believed to be a former lake. Its landing site is thought to have been an ancient river delta, which may contain signs of past life. The rover analyzes the area using its several high-tech but lightweight gadgets and sensors.

The robotic arm has a drill that helps the rover extract rock core samples for study, which will be returned to Earth in the future.

Humans explore the Solar System to understand Earth and its place in the Universe. We have walked on our Moon and sent probes to explore the planets in our Solar System. The robotic rover Perseverance, which launched into space in 2020 and landed on the surface of Mars in 2021, can communicate with Earth using radio signals. Its main tasks are to conduct scientific experiments, gather rock samples that can be sent to Earth for study, and hunt for signs of ancient microscopic life.

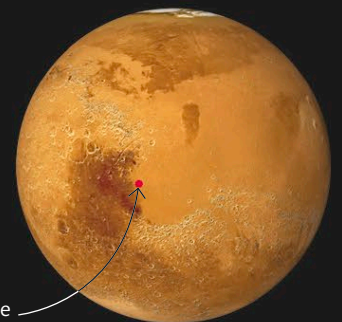
THE SOLAR SYSTEM

In our Solar System, there are eight planets traveling around a star, the Sun. The planets move around the Sun in elliptical paths called orbits. The fourth planet from the Sun, Mars is one of Earth's closest neighbors, 34 million miles (55 million km) away at its nearest point, so we can travel to it in only a few months.



Mars

Famously known as the Red Planet, Mars gets its dusty orange colour from the high levels of iron oxide—the substance that gives rust its colour—on its surface. Plenty of ice has been discovered on Mars that indicates that it was once warmer, wetter, and had a thicker atmosphere—ideal for life. This has spurred scientists to search for signs of microscopic life.



Perseverance landing site